Manager

Rating 4

Comment

SWE3 Review Brandon Murphy

Scope

- PAC (10 SWEs), SWE3.
- Led APD Phase 2 end-to-end across 10+ services, authored Nexus frontend permission gating design, improved reliability and reduced tech debt across PAC/PIE, and multiplied team output through AI skills library.

Accomplishments (in priority order)

- Org | Led and delivered APD Phase 2.
    - Eliminated PIE's runtime dependency on AdvertiserService, removing ~2,500 RPS redundant lookups and rolling 0% to 100% ahead of schedule (1)
    - Implemented across 7 repos: owner caching (seconds to ms, 1), synchronous PIE sync (2), preemptive non-determinism fix (3)
    - Negotiated synchronous approach with Spending Employer team (Slack); helped Jayesh migrate APD streaming events
    - "Brandon contributed crucial changes in Advertiser Service to improve ownership role update operation during the Advertiser Creation process... Brandon was a trusted partner to Spending Employer team for a complex project like APD and provided strong technical and business expertise through review process." -- Jayesh Kshirsagar
- Org | Nexus frontend permission gating.
    - End-to-end delivery: authored design review, broke down epic and delivered all tickets
    - Delivered reusable helpers and route guards across 3+ routes (1, 2, 3)
    - Coordinated with One Host over multiple weeks (Slack)
    - "Brandon identified a simplified architectural path... avoided the 'anti-pattern' of creating redundant permissions and instead re-engineered our existing backend logic." -- Saranya Mohandoss
- Team | Improved reliability and reduced tech debt across PAC/PIE.
    - Fixed 15+ flaky tests and standardized repo hygiene across 14+ repos
    - Examples include: race conditions (1), mock pollution (2), DB replication lag (3), MySQL 5.7 to 8.0 (4), 118 deprecation warnings (5)
    - Found and fixed pie-webapp broken silently in QA (1, 2); migrated pie-tool dashboard to Terraform (1)
    - "Brandon contributed a lot to stabilizing tests across PAC and PIE projects which had been historically flaky." -- Bryan Yoo
- Team | Multiplied team output through AI skills library: 7 reusable AI skills, bulk migration tooling enabling 8 services migrated ahead of deadline, and shared code review helper
    - Created GitLab CLI, Sourcegraph, Slack, Google Docs, ACLI, and APD prompt skills in pac-ai-library; bulk migration prompt (1) cut per-service migration time

- "He completely took advantage of AI and put it to work. He was able to submit MRs for complex services way sooner than any other developer on the team." -- Heber Billings
- "Brandon has shown great initiative in streamlining our code review process through AI-assisted prompts... He has freely offered to collaborate on AI tooling, and shared his prompts with me which have inspired my own creativity with prompt writing and utilizing subagents." -- Tatiana Quintana

Employee

Rating 4

Comment

SWE3 Review Brandon Murphy

Scope

- PAC (Permissions, Access & Controls), 10-person team, SWE3. Joined Oct 2025; cross-team point of contact for permissions by first month.
- Led APD across 10+ services coordinating with 4 teams. Authored Nexus frontend permissions design.
- Metrics: 134 MRs (~1/day) authored & merged, 105 reviewed across 30 repos in Scala, Kotlin, TypeScript, and Java

Accomplishments (in priority order)

- Product/Platform Led APD Phase 2 (PACMAN-1462) end-to-end
  - Coordinated with Spending Employer, CamCap, Interview Platform teams to eliminate PIE's runtime dependency on AdvertiserService, removed ~2,500 RPS redundant lookups, rolled 0%→100% (DataDog, I QL)
  - Planned and implemented Phase 2 across 7 repos.
    - Ex: owner caching (seconds → ms for 1000+ batches, !1752).
    - Ex: synchronous PIE sync (!1437) eliminating new-advertiser race condition.
    - Ex: Caught non-determinism bug preemptively (!607)
  - Negotiated synchronous approach with Spending Employer team citing EVNT-8083 (Slack).
  - Helped Jayesh Kshirsagar migrate APD streaming events (Slack).
  - Fully APD phase 2 compliant ahead of schedule.
  - Continues to own tail end clean up, ETA ~2 weeks
    - Ex: Remove ADVS owner fallback proctors and all associated dead code !1852

    - Heber Billings: "Brandon started on the PAC team towards the end of the APD corgi. He got up to speed quickly. Helped other teams with their APD questions. Really helped move the needle on APD while the rest of the team was focused on Nexus. He worked closely with the advertiser-service team to come up with a solution that supports both team's goals."
- Product Authored Frontend Permissions Design Review (PACMAN-12430) defining Nexus dashboard front end changes
    - Ex: reusable helpers (isNexusOnlyUser across 3+ routes (!922), canViewAnalytics (!889), canViewInterviews (!893))
    - Ex: route guards preventing unauthorized URL access (!922)
    - Ex: Coordinated with One Host team over multiple weeks to land changes (Slack)
- Team Improved code quality and CI reliability across PAC ecosystem by fixing 15+ flaky tests and standardizing repo hygiene across 14+ repos
    - Ex: fixed race conditions (!729)
    - Ex: mock pollution (!1792)
    - Ex: DB replication lag (!1738)
    - Ex: parallel flakiness (!1837)
    - Ex: TestCafe CI timeout (!754)
    - Ex: Fixed 118 deprecation warnings (!1796)
    - Ex: MySQL 5.7 → 8.0 (!1717)
    - Ex: Fixed pie-service pipeline multiple times (example).
    - Ex: Fixed pie-webapp broken silently in QA (SCAPE-181, SCAPE-182).
    - Ex: Migrated pie-tool dashboard to Terraform (PACMAN-12227)
- Team Leveraged AI to multiply results by creating reusable AI skills library, bulk migration tooling, and shared code review helper to accelerate teammates' review cycles
    - Ex: Created 7 AI skills: GitLab CLI (!12), Sourcegraph (!14), Slack (!17), Google Docs (!18), ACLI (!19), APD prompts (!9)
    - Ex: Created bulk migration prompt (!5) reducing time-to-complete per service migration, enabling 8 services migrated ahead of Nov 14 deadline
    - Ex: Shared code review helper with team to speed up MR review cycles.
    - Ex: Shared self eval prompt with team to speed up PE (slack).
    - Heber Billings: "[Brandon] completely took advantage of AI and put it to work. He was able to submit MRs for complex services way sooner than any other developer on the team. He also continues to lead the way with AI and teaches/shares his AI findings with the rest of the team."

Supplemental Information

For more details please see this document.
Here is the Google Drive version of this review.